

DESIGN FILE · UXDC DESIGNATHON 2.0 · HUMAN CONNECTION

porchlight

Leave a light on.

Visual language, components, every prototype screen and the illustration set. Live prototype: viktor-nedev.github.io/porchlight/prototype · Code: github.com/Viktor-Nedev/porchlight

Light = openness. The whole brand is *warm windows in the dark*.

Wick, a shy paper lantern, is the mascot and the emotional arc of the product: dim when alone, glowing when someone says hi. The story site moves from dusk to night over Calgary, so the city literally lights up as the story unfolds.

Every visual choice supports one feeling: **calm, hopeful, never pushy**. No gamified badges, no follower counts, no bright notification reds.



alone hesitant open kindled

Night, dusk, and one warm accent.

Night 900
#0D0B21

Night 700
#1E1A40

Dusk 600
#3A2C6B

Lantern amber
#FFB547

Amber 300
#FFD27A

Paper
#F4ECDF

Chinook peach
#F29E7D

Rose (people)
#E8607A

Teal (time)
#5CC2B6

Violet (people)
#8B7CFF

C-Train red
#E8384F

Ink
#F6F1E7

Amber is reserved for light: lit windows, the lamp button, the user's own light, primary actions. Person colours identify individuals on the map; time and transit use teal and C-Train red. Body text on night backgrounds is #D9D2EA (≥ 7:1).

DISPLAY · FRAUNCES (SOFT, WONKY)

porchlight

Headlines and numbers. Italic in amber for the one emotional word in a line.

TEXT · SCHIBSTED GROTESK

A quiet way to say “I’m open to company.”

Body, UI labels and buttons. A newspaper grotesk: warm, readable, uncommon.

ACCENT · CAVEAT

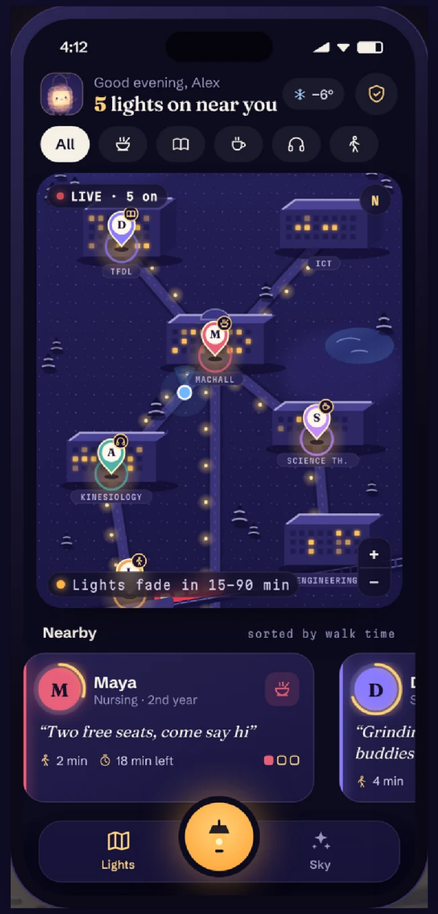
Leave a light on.

Handwritten notes and the tagline only, never body text.

LABELS · MARTIAN MONO · DOTGOTHIC16

01 / 06 · LIVE · 5 ON

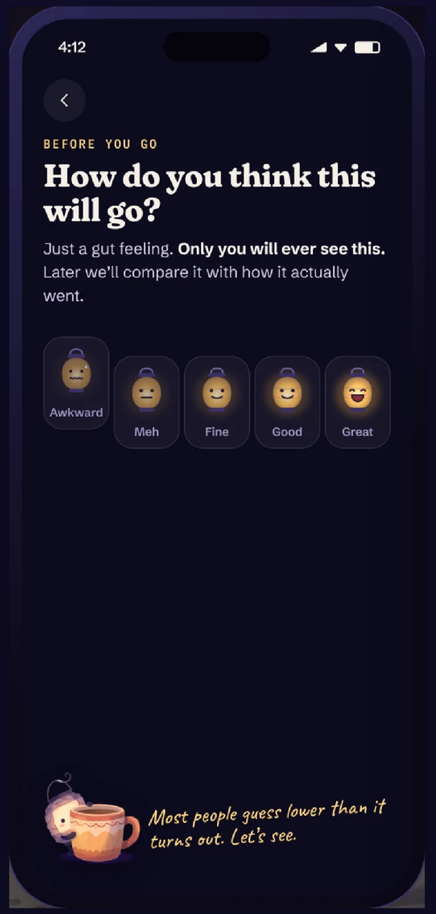
Section numbers, metadata and the C-Train arrival boards (DotGothic16).



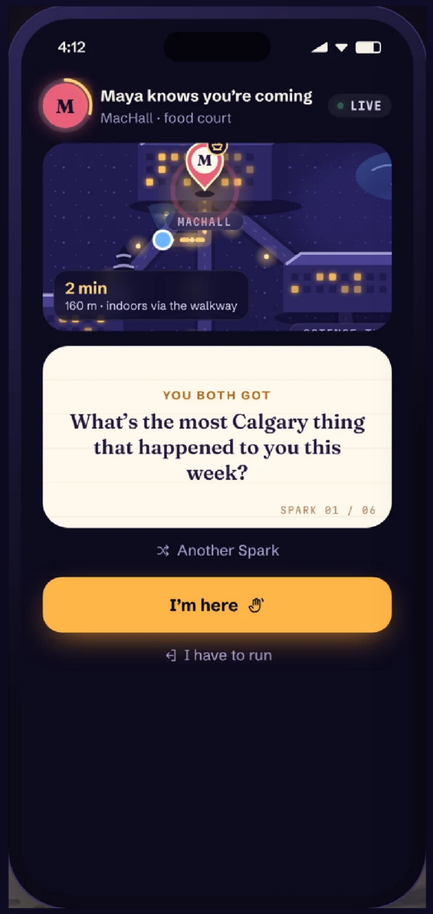
1 · Map of lights



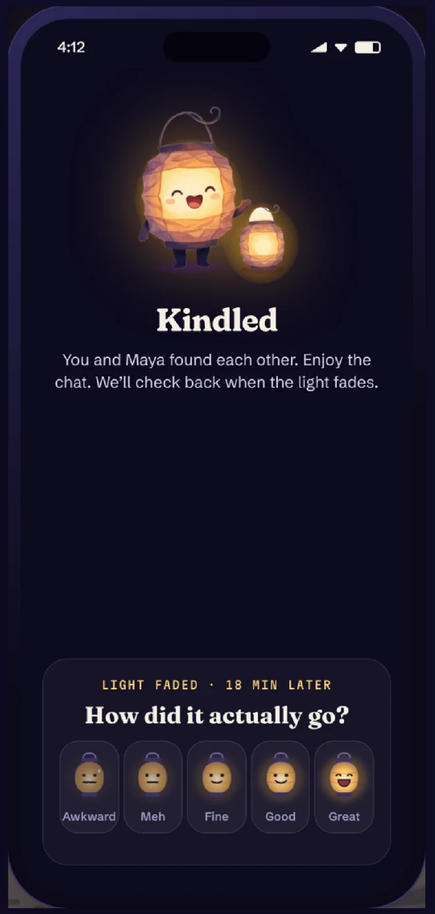
2 · A light: seats, topic, time



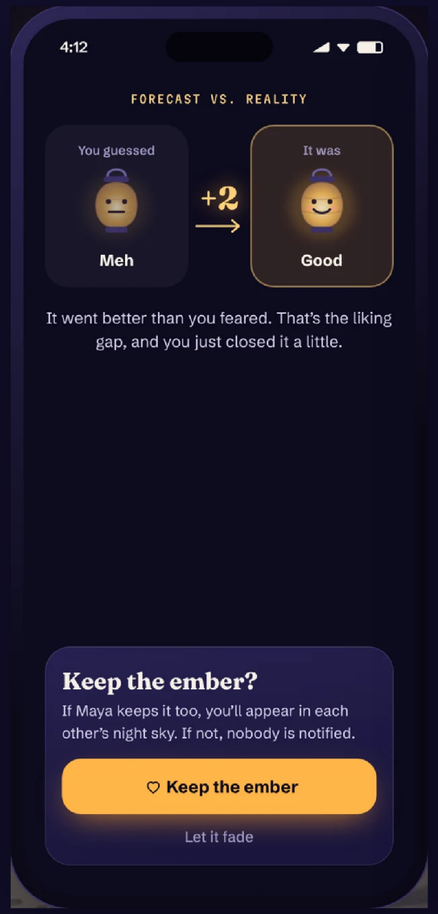
3 · Private forecast



4 · Route + shared Spark



5 · Kindled, how did it go?



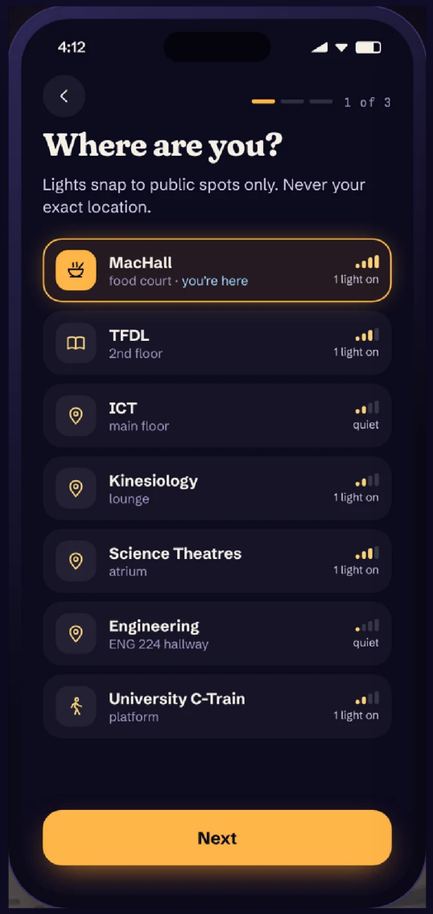
6 · Forecast vs. reality



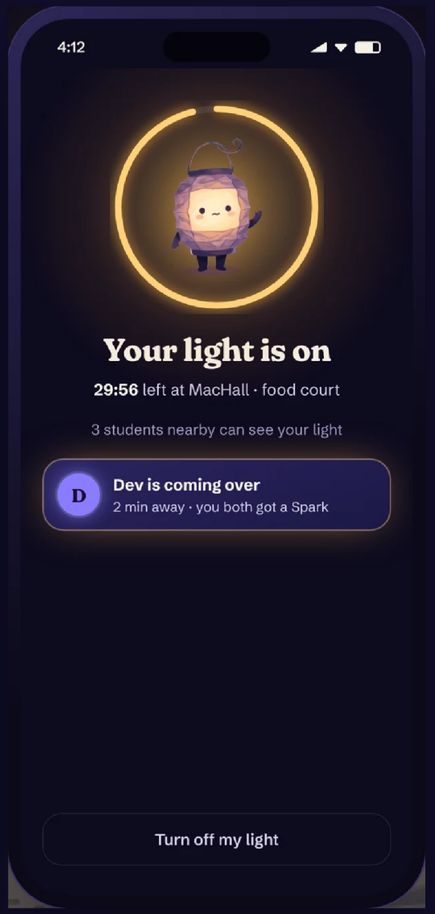
7 · Night sky + warm spots



0 · Welcome



A · Light: where



B · Your light is on

Lantern rating scale

Five lanterns from Awkward to Great; glow and expression grow with the score. Used twice (forecast and reality) so the comparison is visual, not numeric.

Person pin

Teardrop in the person's colour, initial on a paper face, a small vibe badge (food, study, coffee, company, walk). Selected pins scale up 18%.

Time ring

A thin amber ring around each avatar shows time left on that light, so urgency is visible without a countdown.

Seat indicator

Filled squares for taken seats, outlined for free ones; the detail sheet shows the same as a small table diagram.

Spark card

Flips on tap (0.8 s ease-out); "Another Spark" swaps the text in place. Both people always get the same card.

Lamp button

The centre of the tab bar; breathes slowly so the primary action is always discoverable.

Motion

Ease-out (0.22, 1, 0.36, 1), 0.45 s screen transitions; everything respects prefers-reduced-motion.

Accessibility

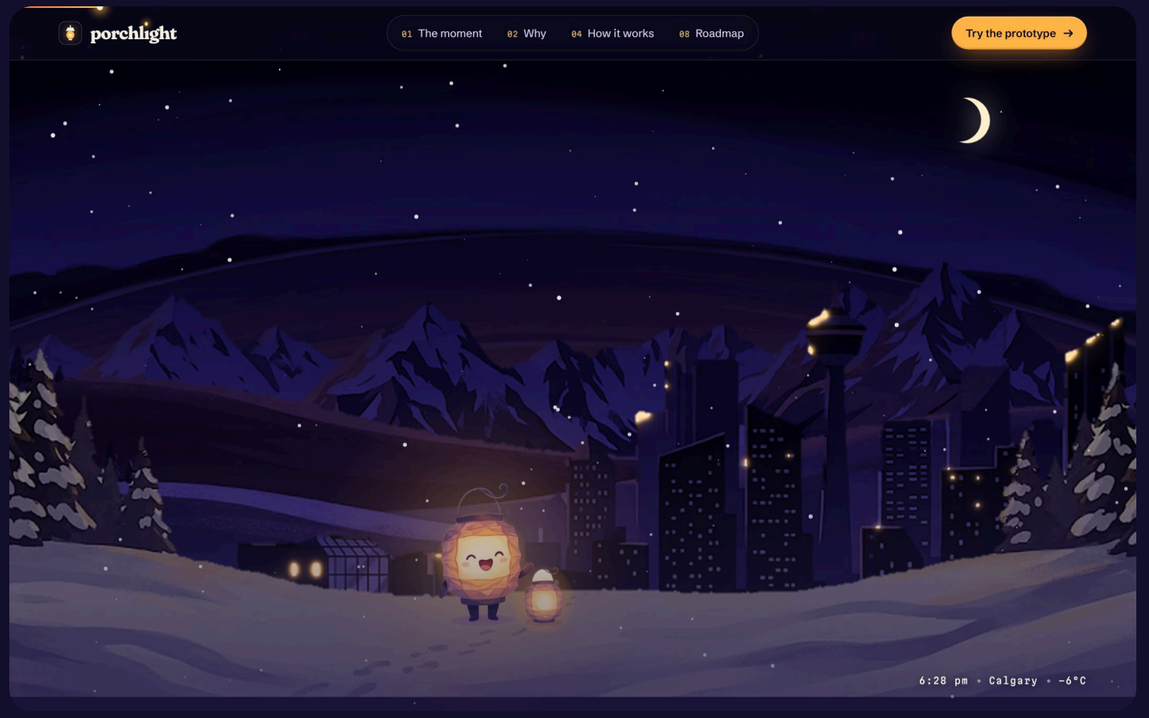
Text ≥ 4.5:1 contrast, labelled icons, keyboard-operable pins and forms, colour never carries meaning alone.

Safety

Shield always in the header; "I have to run" on every in-progress screen; lights snap to public spots only.



Hero at dusk: five painted parallax layers



Scroll to night: windows light up, Wick finds a friend



Interactions: pull-chain preloader, dusk-to-night colour grade, pinned storytelling, C-Train arrival boards with split-flap text, a window that opens onto the campus, a sticky phone that drives the live prototype, taped postcards with 3D tilt, a clickable constellation, a horizontal transit-line roadmap and rising lanterns.

Built with HTML, CSS and JavaScript (GSAP, Lenis). No build step.















Style: painterly flat illustration with gouache texture, limited night-and-amber palette. Prompts and art direction in docs/IMAGE_PROMPTS.md.

Attribution: illustrations generated with [AI image tool name] from the team's prompts, then cut out and retouched by the team. Fonts: Google Fonts (OFL). Motion libraries: GSAP, Lenis.